

Seeing How Many Without Counting

Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

Quick Answers

1. 3	3. 4	5. 4	7. —
2. 5	4. 2	6. 5	8. —

Curriculum

Level: Kindergarten–Grade 1

K.CC.A.1–K.CC.C.7 – *problems 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8*

Difficulty 1–4 of 5 across 8 tagged checks.

How to use this key. Each solution names the *pattern* the child should see, not a counting sequence. If a child counts one-by-one and gets the right number, the answer is correct but the target skill is not yet there — flash the card for about two seconds and ask again.

1. Dot card: three dots on a slanted line (the domino/dice three).

Solution: The three dots sit in the familiar slanted-line pattern. A child who knows this pattern says “three” with no counting; the dots do not need to be touched one at a time. Written as a number, the card shows 3.

2. Dot card: four dots in the corners with one dot in the middle (the dice five).

Solution: This is the dice five: a square of four with one in the centre. Seeing it as “four corners and a middle” is what makes it instant. The card shows 5.

3. Five-frame with one empty box.

Solution: A five-frame is full at five, so read the *empty* boxes instead of the dots. One box is empty, and one less than five is four: $5 - 1 = 4$. The frame shows 4.

4. Five-frame with three empty boxes.

Solution: Three boxes are empty, so the frame is three away from full: $5 - 3 = 2$. The frame shows 2.

5. Two cards, each showing a pair of dots.

Solution: Each card is a pair, and a pair is seen at a glance as two. Two and two more is four: $2 + 2 = 4$. Altogether the cards show 4.

6. One card showing a slanted three, one card showing a pair.

Solution: The left card is the slanted three, the right card is a pair. Hold three in your head and count on two: four, five. As a number sentence, $3 + 2 = 5$, so the cards show 5.

7. Left card: four dots in a square. Right card: three dots on a slant.

Solution: The square pattern is four; the slanted line is three. Four is more than three, so the left card wins and the symbol points at the smaller number: $\boxed{>}$.

8. Left card: two groups of two. Right card: a full five-frame.

Solution: The left card is a pair and another pair, which is $2 + 2 = 4$. The right frame is full, and full means five. Four is less than five, so the correct symbol is $\boxed{<}$. This is the one problem where the bigger-looking card (two separate boxes) holds fewer dots — the child must finish both readings before choosing.